MCP, EXPLAINED

Plug your AI into your tools. Check this first.

MCP lets Claude and ChatGPT read your calendar, files and books. Here is how we would connect one safely, this afternoon.

SWIPE ››



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Know what MCP actually is

MCP is a standard plug. Instead of copying figures into a chat, you connect the AI to the tool and it looks things up itself. Claude, ChatGPT and Gemini all support it, and HubSpot, Shopify and Stripe publish their own.

START WITH

Open the connectors or settings page in your AI app and see what is already listed.



Start with one tool, read-only

Pick the tool where a wrong answer costs least, like your calendar or shared files. Ask it to find and summarise, not to send or change anything. Add a second tool only once the first behaves.

START WITH

Connect one tool and ask it a question you can check yourself.



Use connectors from the vendor, not a lookalike

One research census counted 21,643 servers in a public registry in August 2026. Researchers have flagged lookalike names and weak ownership checks. A server you add can see what you let it see.

START WITH

Only add connectors linked from the tool vendor's own help pages.



Make it ask before it acts

Connected means it can do things, not just read. In May 2026 the US NSA said MCP adoption had outpaced its security model. Keep approval on for anything that sends, posts, deletes or pays.

START WITH

Switch on ask-before-acting and never auto-approve payments.



Expect gaps, and one more company

Not every product has a one-click connector. Xero's own server reportedly has to be run by a developer, so owners often go through a third-party service. That is one more business holding access to your books.

START WITH

Search your software vendor's developer page for MCP before paying anyone.

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Test it on a task you can verify

Ask for something with a known answer, like this week's meetings or last month's unpaid invoices, then check it against the real tool. Wrong answers on a known task mean you should not trust it on an unknown one.

START WITH

Run one known-answer check before you rely on any connector.



Connect carefully. Then let it work.

This is the order we would follow with a client: one tool, read-only, vendor connector, approvals on, then a test.

Which one tool would you connect to your AI first, and what would you ask it?